

6.2 Assessment information

Choice of pathways

In this unit students must complete activities **a** and **b** as in Unit 3 in the AS internal assessment. However, for activities **c** and **d** there will be a choice of pathways they can follow. They can follow **pathway 1** with activities **c** and **d** assessed separately, as in AS. Or they can follow **pathway 2**, which assesses activities **c** and **d** together in a multi-stage experiment.

Controlled conditions

All these activities must be carried out under controlled conditions. Students will be allowed to write up their practical reports in a separate lesson, but their materials must be collected at the end of the session and handed back at the beginning of the next session. Students are not permitted to work on their practical sheets out of the lesson. Students work must be individual and they may not work with other students in groups.

Assessed practical sheets

The practical sheets for activities **b**, **c**, **d** and the multi-stage experiment are confidential and must not be shown to students prior to their completion of them. They will be available on a secure Edexcel website for teachers to download in preparation for delivery.

Activities**Activity a: General Practical Competence (GPC)**

This will confirm that the students have completed a range of practicals over the whole year and developed their laboratory skills. Students must have carried out at least five practicals in class.

Students will have to complete practical activities as part of Units 1 and 2. By completing these practicals students will be able to:

- follow and interpret experimental instructions, covering the full range of laboratory exercises set throughout the course, with minimal help from the teacher
- always work with interest and enthusiasm in the laboratory completing most laboratory exercises in the time allocated
- manipulate apparatus, use chemicals, carry out all common laboratory procedures and use data logging (where appropriate) with the highest level of skill that may be reasonably expected at this level
- work sensibly and safely in the laboratory paying due regard to health and safety requirements without the need for reminders from the teacher
- gain accurate and consistent results in quantitative exercises, make most of the expected observations in qualitative exercises and obtain products in preparations of high yield and purity.

There will be no separate mark awarded for these practical activities.

Verification of completion of these practicals is required as well as the core practical code, or title of an alternative practical, field of chemistry and dates on which the practicals were carried out.

Activity b: Qualitative observation

Students must complete one qualitative observation, from the selection provided by Edexcel. This activity will include a student sheet, teacher and technician notes and a mark scheme. The activity is marked out of 14.

Pathway 1

Activity c: Quantitative measurement

Students must complete one quantitative measurement, from the selection provided by Edexcel. This activity will include a student sheet, teacher and technician notes and a mark scheme. The activity is marked out of 14.

Activity d: Preparation

Students must complete one preparation (making a chemical), from the selection provided by Edexcel. This activity will include a student sheet, teacher and technician notes and a mark scheme. The activity is marked out of 12.

Pathway 2

Multi-stage experiment

Students could complete a multi-stage experiment, comprising of a quantitative measurement and a preparation. This will cover the same criteria as activities **c** and **d**, but allow students experience of a longer and different practical activity. This activity must be chosen from the selection provided by Edexcel. It will include a student sheet, teacher and technician notes and a mark scheme. The activity is marked out of 26.